

The manufacturer robot

Rethink Robotics is based in Boston, America. There's a significant level of excitement around Rethink's robotic offering and not just because it's owned by Rodney Brook whose first startup has given us the iRobot. Rethink's robot is called Baxter and it's said to be the world's first robot which can work along with people in a manufacturing setup without the use of safety cages.

Baxter is only vaguely shaped like a human and comes equipped with an array of sensors and cameras which the robot uses for adaptive learning. The robot has the ability to avoid collisions, adjust itself to change in the speed of conveyor belts and also recall objects. It can even bring operations to a halt in case of ambiguous conditions or if it has perceived that something outside the desired parameters is underway. The setup for this rather complex robot can be done in under an hour.



Making stuff, following one command at a time

Baxter is said to be considerably more affordable than its more clunky peers. This means that, at least in the US, reduced outsourcing among manufacturers - especially small organizations could be on the horizon.

The medical robot

It's been more than a decade since the California based company, 'In Touch Health' has been creating remote-presence robots catering to the healthcare industry. These robots are already working in at least 700 hospitals and handle physician-patient interactions rather well, going by the reports. The firm's model called RP-VITA became the very first to be cleared by the FDA (Food and Drug Administration) that consists of autonomous navigation technology for telemedicine.

VITA's development was done by partnering with iRobot. The robot moves around at a reasonable walking pace. Its awareness of its surround-